Andrew Avitabile

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Contact Information

915 Elliott Avenue
Charlottesville, VA
22902

andrewavit@gmail.com
andrew-avitabile.com
(203) 247-1235

Research Areas

Quantitative methods, causal inference, teacher labor markets, K–12 education policy and leadership, natural language processing, education in low- and middle-income countries

Education

University of Virginia, School of Education and Human Development
Ph.D., Education Policy, 2027 (Expected)

University of Virginia, Frank Batten School of Public Policy
Master of Public Policy, 2024

The George Washington University
B.S., Economics, 2015

Awards & Grants

AERA-NSF Dissertation Grant (2027), American Educational Research Association and National Science Foundation — $27,500

Dwight D. Eisenhower / Clifford Roberts Graduate Fellowship (2026 – 2027), Eisenhower Institute at Gettysburg College — $10,000

Bankard Fund for Political Economy, Pre-doctoral Dissertation Fellowship (2026), University of Virginia — $21,000

Graduate Dissertation Fellowship *Semi-Finalist* (2026 – 2027), National Academy of Education and Spencer Foundation

Virginia Education Science Training (VEST) Fellow (2022 – 2026), Institute for Education Sciences

Global Graduate Research Grant (Fall 2023), University of Virginia — $1,500, *Evaluating a Comprehensive School Health Program in Zambia* [link]

Hsieh Prize for Best Undergraduate Thesis in Economics (2015), The George Washington University Department of Economics

Refereed Journal Publications

1. Bartanen, B., Kwok, A., **Avitabile, A.**, and Kim, B.H. (2024). Why Do You Want to Be a Teacher? A Natural Language Processing Approach. *Educational Researcher*. [link] JIF: 4.9, 5-yr JIF: 7.5, Citations: 23. Media Coverage: EdSurge.

Working Papers

3. Bartanen, B., **Avitabile, A.**, and Kwok, A. (2025). Who Wants to Be a Teacher in America? *Resubmitted at American Educational Research Journal*. [link]. Citations: 7. Media Coverage: The74Million. Fordham Institute.

2. **Avitabile, A.**, Bartanen, B., and Kwok, A (2025). Using Large Language Models to Analyze Preservice Teacher Feedback and Reflections During Clinical Teaching. *Submitted*. [link]. Citations: 2.

1. **Avitabile, A.** Screen or Barrier? Science of Reading Certification Exams and Teacher Supply in Texas. (2026). [link].

Works In Progress

5. **Avitabile, A.** Evaluation of the Teacher Retention Allotment.
4. Lagarde, M., Mbiti, I., **Avitabile, A.**, Grabowska, M., & Beimba, G. Evaluating the Impact of a Comprehensive School Health Program in Zambia. [AEA RCT Registry]
3. **Avitabile, A.**, Bartanen, B., and Kwok, A. Identifying Effective K–12 Teachers Using Clinical Teaching Data. *Draft Available Upon Request.*
2. Bartanen, B., **Avitabile, A.**, and Callen, I. Exploring the Stability of Teacher Value-Added Estimates.
1. **Avitabile, A.** and Mbiti, I. International Teachers in the United States.

Policy Briefs & Reports

2. **Avitabile, A.** and Cruz, L. (2025). What Student Teachers Value in Internships: Evidence from the PAAP Program in Salvador, Bahia. World Bank Education Note. [link]
1. **Avitabile, A.**, and Konkel, A. Employer Demand for Interns Falls to Pre-Pandemic Levels but Remains Strong. *Indeed Hiring Lab.* [link]

Conference Presentations

6. **Avitabile, A.** (2026). Screen or Barrier? Science of Reading Certification Exams and Teacher Supply in Texas. Paper to be presented at the annual meeting of the Association for Public Policy and Management. Boston, MA.
5. **Avitabile, A.** (2026). Evaluation of the Teacher Retention Allotment. Paper presented at the annual meeting of Association for Education Finance and Policy. Chicago, IL.
4. **Avitabile, A.**, Bartanen, B., and Kwok, A. (2025). Using Large Language Models to Analyze Pre-service Teacher Feedback and Reflections. Paper presented at the Education Reform Then and Now: 20th Anniversary Policy Conference, Department of Education Reform, University of Arkansas. Fayetteville, AR.
3. **Avitabile, A.**, Bartanen, B., and Kwok, A. (2025). Using Large Language Models to Analyze Pre-service Teacher Feedback and Reflections. Paper presented at the annual meeting of Association for Education Finance and Policy. Washington, DC.
2. Bartanen, B., Kwok, A., **Avitabile, A.**, and Kim, B.H. (2023). Why Do You Want to Be a Teacher? A Natural Language Processing Approach. Paper presented at the annual meeting of the Association for Public Policy and Management. Atlanta, GA.
1. Bartanen, B., Kwok, A., **Avitabile, A.**, and Kim, B.H. (2023). Why Do You Want to Be a Teacher? A Natural Language Processing Approach. Paper presented at the annual meeting of Association for Education Finance and Policy. Denver, CO.

Work Experience

Short Term Consultant, World Bank — July 2026 – Present
Remote

Research Manager, Professor Sarah Turner — June 2026 – Present
Charlottesville, VA

Indeed Hiring Lab, Associate Economist, — June 2021 – August 2022
Remote

Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab, Research Assistant, — October 2019 – May 2021
Cambridge, MA

Mais Caminhos, English Teacher, — November 2018 – October 2019
Rio De Janeiro, Brazil

MDRC, Technical Research Assistant II, May 2017 – October 2018
New York, NY

NERA Economic Consulting, Associate Analyst, May 2015 – April 2017
New York, NY

Courses Taught

University of Virginia
EDLF 5330: Quantitative Methods and Data Analysis I (Fall 2025)
Co-Instructed with Brendan Bartanen

Skills

Programming:
Advanced: R, Stata, LaTeX, Excel
Intermediate: SAS
Basic: Python, SQL

Survey Design Tools:
Advanced: SurveyCTO, Qualtrics

Languages:
English (Native), Portuguese (Advanced)

Other:
Certified Trainer for World Bank TEACH Observation Tool (ECE, Primary, and Secondary)

References

Brendan Bartanen
Associate Professor of Education and Public Policy
University of Virginia
bartanen@virginia.edu

Jim Wyckoff
Memorial Professor of Education
University of Virginia
wyckoff@virginia.edu

Sara Rimm-Kaufman
Commonwealth Professor of Education
Chair, Department of Education Leadership, Foundations and Policy
University of Virginia
serk@virginia.edu

Allison Atteberry
Associate Professor of Education and Public Policy
University of Virginia
acma@virginia.edu

Service

Reviewer (Academic Journals): *Journal of Teacher Education*; *Annals of Dyslexia*

Reviewer (Academic Conferences): *Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness* 2026; *Association for Public Policy and Management* 2026

Other: Volunteer for Big Brothers Big Sisters Central Blue Ridge 2023 – Present